

Element A-B:

Mastery Copy

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Creating a Mini Golf Course for Our School :

What is our problem and why is it important? Our situation may not be the same or as drastic as people in need of food, but another topic that is important to address is people's mental health, specifically in school.

The problem is that people, including students and teachers can be awfully stressed from draining work, especially during exam or testing season. A way we can relieve some of that stress is by constructing a mini golf course!

This matters because the mental health of our students & staff are very important. Everybody's performance is off when they're tired or stressed. This leads to poor mental and potentially physical health. Playing mini golf promotes hand-eye coordination. Children can improve their ability to aim while attempting to get the ball into the holes on the course. Mini golf also encourages players to control their strength.---monsterminigolf.com

Students, faculty, administration, ourselves, and others not yet specified will be involved in this problem. The students would be the ones supporting the play of the mini golf courses mostly. Faculty and administration will oversee, discuss, approve or disapprove ideas. Ourselves, also being stakeholders, will help the making, creation, and ideas put into this project with ourselves and everyone in mind.

Everyone plays their role, and everyone is open to play and enjoy the fun activity of mini golf!

The mini golf course project will occur in the open grass area between GHS and GES. We think this space has plenty of room for a mini golf course, with a few courses. We are all creating ideas for golf holes, courses, design, and making sure we have criteria for this project, including: safety, enjoyment, practicality, including relation to the school, within the budget, uniqueness (to not get bored too fast)etc.. We will present our ideas inside our engineering class and present our final idea to administration by the end of this school year. This mini golf course will be built after administration approves, and the building of it will occur at later determined times. This is unique because normally, schools do not provide their students with a mini golf course on campus.

The size of this issue could range all over the world, being that stress is our main problem. According to crossrivertherapy.com, across the world, 45% of students in highschool admit to being stressed almost everyday in school. 61% of teenagers in the world between the ages of 13 and 17 also feel stress over producing satisfactory grades.

How does this problem affect outer sources? A mini golf course can affect not only our school but others in our district as well.

Other schools and countries face the same problem, of the mental and physical health of their students and teachers. In America, 75% of U.S highschool students expressed boredom, anger, sadness, fear, or stress while in school. On a 10-point scale, where normal values for adults are 3.8, American teens rated their stress rate an average score of 5.8. In other academic pressure statistics, it was found out that three-quarters (75%) of American highschoolers and half of the middle schoolers described themselves as “often or always feeling stressed,” by schoolwork.---research.com

In other countries like China, Japan, South Korea, Finland, Singapore, and more, it is reported that they are the highest stressed-from-schoolwork countries in the world other than the U.S.. An activity like mini golf could help reduce the numbers.

Primary stakeholders would be students, teachers, community, and people who participate in the activity. Their roles will be to play the mini golf courses. Depending on how mini golf can be a relaxing activity while also boosting senses to score, a positive impact would affect the primary stakeholders. Secondary stakeholders could be teachers(again), administration, community members, etc.. Depending on the results from the primary stakeholders' experience, teachers and their students will have less percentage of stress, better focus, better grades, etc.

Student concerns would include "Is it fun?" or "how or when can I play it?" A few community concerns might be, "Is it open for everyone to play?", "How does this benefit anybody?", "How old do you have to be to participate?" Teacher concerns may be "Can my children play?", "Can teachers and faculty participate, or is it just for the students?", "Will this be a distraction, or will it be used for a Administration concerns could involve, "Is it safe, or kid-friendly?", "Does it disrupt the drainage?" "Could it harm outside sources such as cars, people, etc.?", "How soon are we planning to build this?"

Previous studies by [research.com](https://www.research.com) shows the stress levels in the U.S. from students are higher than the average adult. Studies from [mastersdegree.net](https://www.mastersdegree.net) show the "Top 10 Toughest Education Systems in the world," Ex: South Korea, Finland, Singapore, China, Japan, Hong Kong, etc.. Other studies from sites like [monsterminigolf.com](https://www.monsterminigolf.com) show how the activity of mini golf can benefit children and students.

How severe is this problem? Why does it need a solution? The severity of student stress is getting worse by the years. On [news.gallup.com](https://www.news.gallup.com), studies show that there is "No slowing down in the rate of students considering stopping out." It also shows how "About

four in 10 students (41%) currently enrolled in a postsecondary education program say they have considered ‘stopping out’ in the past six months, a slight rise from 2020 and 2021. “This situation could expand and get worse without proper attention. They explain furthermore that, “Researchers have long warned of a growing mental health crisis on U.S. college campuses. Students are increasingly likely to report problems with depression and anxiety, and demand for campus counseling services has risen past the capacity of many schools to keep up with it. The situation was exacerbated by the COVID-19 pandemic.

Previous attempts to solve our problem at hand, or similar problems, according to navigate360.com, include: Expanding Social-Emotional Learning (SEL) Programs, Hiring more Mental Health Personnel (Ex: counselors, nurses, social workers, and psychologists), and providing mental health support for students such as the Project AWARE (Advance Wellness and Resilience in Education) program to help fund school-based practices such as: Mental health screening, early intervention and prevention, and treatment.

According to stemnext.org, schools that provide afterschool STEM activities have positive impacts on students. “In fact, research shows that high-quality, expanded STEM learning opportunities can improve academic outcomes, increase college and career readiness, and foster positive youth development. They also offer spaces for youth-led solutions to real-world problems which will lead to a new generation of problem solvers in STEM fields.” “For young people, after school programs have always been safe spaces to build social-emotional skills alongside learning and interacting with others.”

Some colleges and universities have actually added a minigolf course to their campus. On harrisminigolf.com under the heading “Benefits of Constructing a Mini Golf Course on College Campuses and Universities”, they state that “Mini golf courses lend themselves

well to college campuses for a host of reasons. Beneficial to both students and faculty, a miniature golf course can be the perfect place for students to form new friendships and take part in a constructive activity while not in class. College sports can be great for bonding and team building, but not everyone is a competitive athlete. Miniature golf presents an alternative to those who might want the feeling of being a team without the commitment and competition involved in college sports.” We have not found many previous attempts in tackling this situation similarly, these are to list the few that were worth writing for this section.

From navigate360.com they state and list their ways they have helped students mental health, starting in early 2021 till now, “Navigate360 solutions are used by more than 35,000 schools, 5,000 law enforcement agencies, and 4,400 businesses nationwide to help organizations prepare and respond in ways proven to save lives and help communities thrive.” All of their solutions and studies have shown and proven to help students overcome stress and learn about mental health. They do not state any more information about results.

From stemnext.org, they show that through their after-school and STEM activities, students have shown a positive attitude in school, became more comfortable in the environment, and made their own personal benefits for their mental health. A quote from a student participating in their program says, “I used to be really quiet in school and turn down opportunities that came to me. I'm not that person anymore. I've made new friends in my program, especially with girls that are similar to me and want to pursue some of the same things.

Finally, on harrisminigolf.com, they previously state the benefits of their minigolf courses at schools, “By providing fun activities such as minigolf on college campuses, higher education institutions can not only help ease the transition to college life, but also make their students’ experiences on campus even more enjoyable.” Easing student stress levels in the process, their minigolf courses have been

built and helped more than 800 clients and also their players, across the world. “Our extensive portfolio of satisfied customers showcases positive feedback across the board.”